Tesfatseyon Merkinh

Video Editor | Short-Form & High-Retention Content

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PROFILE

Video editor focused on short-form, high-retention content for TikTok, Instagram Reels, and YouTube Shorts. Experienced cutting for a range of clients and niches, with an eye for pacing, hooks, and story structure that keep viewers watching to the end. Comfortable working end-to-end in CapCut and DaVinci Resolve — from raw footage to color, sound, captions, and export-ready delivery across formats. Brings a technical background in software development, which translates into fast tool adoption, organized project files, and a methodical approach to testing what actually improves watch time.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Video Editor — Short-Form Content

Remote / Independent • 2024 – Present

- Edit short-form videos for clients across a mix of niches, delivering content optimized for TikTok, Instagram Reels, and YouTube Shorts.
- Structure edits around strong opening hooks, tight pacing, and clean cuts to maximize watch-through and retention.
- Handle the full workflow in CapCut and DaVinci Resolve: rough cuts, color grading, audio sync, sound design, and platform-ready exports.
- Add captions, on-screen text, and simple motion elements to boost accessibility and scroll-stopping impact.
- Manage multiple client projects and turnaround deadlines, keeping organized, versioned project files.

Content Creator — Personal Short-Form Projects

Independent • 2023 – Present

- Plan, shoot, and edit personal short-form content, using it as a testing ground for hooks, pacing, and trend formats.
- Iterate on edits based on audience retention and engagement patterns to sharpen editing decisions over time.

Frontend & Web Developer

Freelance / Academic Projects — Dilla University, Ethiopia • 2023 – 2024

- Built and deployed responsive websites, including a hotel design site and a university fellowship website, with a focus on clean UI and cross-device usability.
- Background in structured, detail-oriented technical work — a skillset that carries directly into organized editing workflows and fast adoption of new creative tools.

KEY SKILLS

- Short-form editing (TikTok / Reels / Shorts)
- Hook writing & retention-driven pacing
- CapCut & DaVinci Resolve
- Color correction & grading
- Sound design, music sync & captions
- Repurposing long-form into short clips
- Trend & platform-algorithm awareness
- Client communication & fast turnaround

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science

Dilla University, Ethiopia. Expected 2027.

HOBBIES & INTERESTS

- Short-form video trends
- Travelling
- Classic films
- Learning new languages